



macOS backdoor

A custom-built command and control server can be used as new spying capabilities in a variant of the FruitFly backdoor. <http://dgit.in/macOSbd>



Tor-based messaging app

Tor-based "Briar" messaging app enters public beta. It uses the Tor network to send and receive messages. <http://dgit.in/torbasedapp>

Bite Back!

Want to save the world?
Start eating bugs...

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efore you go into a string of "Ewws", you should know that the tendency to react that way is probably

genetically encoded into you. Centuries and more of associating insects with disease, garbage, and a general invasion of your home has calibrated a fear that is not entirely unknown or unexplored: <http://dgit.in/EwwBugs>. That fear needs to be overcome. According to the Food and Agriculture Organisation (FAO), by 2050 the earth will have 9 billion humans living on it, and current methods of food production can't feed that many. There just isn't enough arable land to be able to grow enough grain and vegetables for that many people, and we know meat isn't the answer either. We need to reevaluate what we eat – and eating insects (entomophagy) might be the answer.

GOOD BUGS

Insects have been considered as a viable source of protein by many cultures and regions around the world. According to estimates, insects already form a part of the traditional diets of more than 2 billion people – which includes more than 1900 species of insects!

Before we get into nutritional information, let's first take a look at what insects contribute already. For instance, insects help in pollination so that plants can reproduce. More than 90 per cent of the 250,000 flowering species in the world depend mainly on insects for pollination. They also significantly contribute to soil fertilisa-

tion through waste conversion. Apart from these they have many other contributions such as natural control over harmful pests, by-products like honey, silk and medical applications as well. Insects actually contribute far more than we humans do to the ecology of the planet!

A LA CARTE

As we mentioned earlier, eating insects is not a new food habit. In fact, if you take a map of the world and a list of the countries where insects



Bees are a major pollinating insect species – a lot of flowering plants depend on them for reproduction

are a major part of the diet, it is not hard to spot a trend. As you get closer to the equator, the number of insect species being consumed by the local populations increases. Beetles make up about 40 per cent of all known insect species, and about 31 per cent of known edible species.

What's hard to do is to put numbers to the nutritional value of insects. This is because there are way too many different species to keep a track of, and even within a known species, the nutritional value varies depending on the stage of its lifecycle, the locale and the diet of the insect species itself. Then there's the preparation method (raw, or processed by frying, boiling, drying, pickling, etc.) which also affects the contribution to your diet. In order to bring more clarity, the International Network of Food Data Systems (INFOODS), established in 1984, aims to stimulate and coordinate efforts to improve the quality and worldwide availability of food analysis data. Their efforts include insect-based values as well.

When it comes to their composition, insects are mainly a source of

